

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 1♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣8

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥3

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠4

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 6
♥ Q 8 6 3
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ 8 5

♠ J 9 2
♥ A 10 9 5
♦ Q J 5
♣ K 10 9



♠ A 5 3
♥ 4 2
♦ A K 2
♣ J 7 6 4 2

♠ K 10 7 4
♥ K J 7
♦ 10 7 6
♣ A Q 3

EAST has 13 points but she has to pass. She cannot Double without support for ♥s. She cannot bid 1NT without 2 more points. She cannot overcall 2♣ with a terrible suit like that.

And WEST of course must also pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by North

Lead: ♦K

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ 6 3 2
♣ K 6 5 4

♠ 10 3

♥ K J 7 6

♦ K J 5

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ 9 7 5

♥ A 10 5

♦ A 10 9 4

♣ J 10 9

♠ K Q J 8 4 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ 8 3

SOUTH obviously has to pass when EAST opens 1 ♠.

NORTH has a reasonable Takeout Double. She hopes SOUTH will name a suit and they can just play a partscore.

You should almost always bid when partner makes a Takeout Double. Almost always. This is the one time when you don't. SOUTH's ♠ are so good that he passes, converting the Takeout Double into a Penalty Double.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

Pass

Dbl

All Pass

1 ♠ by East

Lead: ♣8

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 6 3
 ♥ 6 5 3
 ♦ J 10 3
 ♣ A J 9 8

♠ Q J 5

♥ A K Q 2

♦ A 9 8 5

♣ 4 2



♠ 10 4

♥ 10 7 4

♦ Q 4 2

♣ K Q 10 7 3

♠ A K 8 7 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ K 7 6

♣ 6 5

SOUTH has a normal overcall of 1 ♠.

NORTH has a really good hand, but he doesn't have to worry about missing a slam since SOUTH will not have more than 16 points. So he just bids what he thinks SOUTH can make, 4 ♠.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♥ 3

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 6 5
♥ 8 4
♦ K J 10 3
♣ A J 8 4

♠ A J 8 4

♥ 10 9 7

♦ A 8 4

♣ K 7 2



♠ K Q 3
♥ K Q J 5 3
♦ 9 6 5
♣ 10 6

♠ 9 7 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ Q 7 2

♣ Q 9 5 3

EAST has 12 points and a good enough suit to
overcall 1 ♥.

WEST has 9 points with a good ♦ stopper. She bids
1NT.

EAST has nothing more to say, and lets WEST play
1NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

1 ♥

Pass

1NT

All Pass

1NT by West

Lead: ♠ 4